

US\$10 per square inch for three copies of four-layer boards.

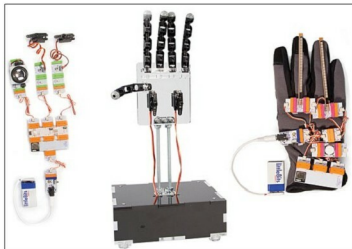
2. How do I make my own vehicle?

You might not intend to really compete with the Tatas and Toyotas of this world, but have you ever wished that you could build your own vehicle, for kicks or due to any special needs? Well, OSVehicle (<http://www.osvehicle.com>) or OSV is an upcoming open source vehicle platform that offers a way out. Their first prototype, Tabby, was showcased at last year's Maker Faire. Tabby is a versatile, universal chassis on which you can build a variety of vehicles ranging from two, three or four seaters to even cargo carriers, capable of travelling up to 80 kilometres per hour. With their starter kit, you can supposedly assemble Tabby in less than an hour! Tabby is certified as road-safe and also complies with environmental norms. OSV technology is compatible with all types of engines—electric, hybrid and internal combustion. All the plans and blueprints can be downloaded from their website and modified at will. The forum is quite active and can be a medium to share your ideas, solve your problems and collaborate on new projects. OSVehicle, like most successful OS businesses, offers two modes to build your vehicle—do it yourself, or do it together. The former means downloading all the designs and doing it all yourself, while the latter includes paid services and support.

You can also check out OScar (<http://www.theoscarproject.org/>), another project aiming to reinvent mobility using OS.

3. How do I get my kids interested in OS?

Many like to see their kids do what they like to do themselves! While that can be quite imposing many a times, it could turn out positively in the case of OS electronics, because it is a great means of science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) learning in the early years



littleBits offers open source electronic building blocks that can be used to learn or prototype electronics (Courtesy: littleBits)

and deeper exploration later. Luckily, OS electronics has some nice goodies for kids too.

Although it might not seem directly like an electronics project, Scratch (<http://scratch.mit.edu/>), a project of the Lifelong Kindergarten Group of MIT Media Labs, is a great way to get your kids started with programming—a life skill to survive in the electronics community! Scratch lets them visually program and create interactive stories, games and animations, which can be shared with the thriving online community. Scratch is sure to teach kids—or even adults—to think and reason multi-dimensionally and work collaboratively, another must-have OS skill.

Kids might find littleBits (<http://littlebits.cc/>) very interesting too.



Scratch is a fun way for kids to learn essential open source skills like visual programming, collaboration, etc

It offers an easy way to understand, develop and prototype electronics while making it all seem like child's play, literally, with their colourful building blocks! littleBits is an OS library of electronic modules that

snap together with tiny magnets. No wiring, soldering or programming. Snap them together and they start working. Take them apart, and make something new. They work just like building blocks that kids play with. cloudBit, another snap-on module, enables kids to join the Internet of Things (IoT) bandwagon too. Now, making a smart towel holder or SMS-controlled calling bell is child's play! Several interesting kits and bundles of littleBits modules are on sale online.

If you are an electronics-pro, you would probably just want to pick up some projects or parts, roll up your sleeves and get started with your little helper! However, before you indulge in any OS project with your kids, keep in mind the fun aspect. As Dave Neary, an OS expert at Red Hat explains in

one of his blog posts, "As long as their hands are in gunk and they are taking things apart, or there's the possibility of blowing something up, kids will stay interested. As soon as the activity starts to seem like work, they switch off."

4. How do I get parts for my projects?

Open source means lot of trial and error, experimentation and freedom to try things out. However, all of us know OS or free software is not necessarily fi-